However, it has never offered any clarity on the exact quantum of such borrowings in the budget nor provided specific disclosure relating to the entities through which it planned to channelise extra-budgetary resources. Thus, the full disclosure recommended by the FFC has not been made. While such OBBs stood at Rs 1,11,898.7 crore as of March 2021, the outstanding guarantees extended by the state government to the institutions concerned stood at Rs 96,448 crore.

Such accounting practices also impact transparency in reporting financial transactions. Many of the institutions do not have revenue resources to repay the loans provided by the government. For example, the detailed project report of KLIS stated that the project would hardly generate any revenue as water was being provided at nominal rates for irrigation in drought-prone regions. Similarly, the Telangana State Sheep and Goat Development Cooperative Federation Limited did not have any definite stream of revenue of its own and was, in fact, only a matter of implementing a government subsidy scheme. The liability of loans taken by institutions that are unable to generate enough resources to service the debts will eventually have to be shouldered by the government.

"Heavy borrowing to sustain the hyper-populist welfare measures is costing the economy dearly and, in the long run, may lead to disaster," says M. Padmanabha Reddy, secretary of the Forum for Good Governance. Instead of borrowing to fund such programmes, he suggests the state increase budget allocations for education, health and infrastructure.

seven years), introducing a one-stop clearance system (the Telangana State Industrial Project Approval and Self-Certification System or TS-iPASS), besides conjuring up a holistic Strategic Road Development Programme to ease commuting in capital city Hyderabad. Touted as key to pursuing its goal of "welfare to every house, happiness on every face", the government has also launched 30-odd welfare schemes since 2014. Implementation has been tardy. Although expenditure on 400-plus schemes went up from Rs 30,000 crore in 2014 to Rs 94,000 crore in 2022, poor delivery mechanisms have led to a huge number of complaints about not getting the benefits in time—or not at all. Minimal official monitoring has not helped assuage a restive public.

In fact, according to recent feedback received by KCR himself, only the Rythu Bandhu (investment support) and Rythu Bima (crop insurance) schemes for farmers are being implemented effectively. Under an initiative for pregnant women and newborns, 'KCR Kits'—which include 16 items such as baby soap, napkins and diapers—are being handed out, but the beneficiaries are not getting the promised

NATIONAL EGG CO-ORDINATION COMMITTEE

National Egg Coordination Committee (NECC) has appealed to the Government of India to allot at least 2.0 million tons of damaged Wheat, Paddy and/or Broken Rice - unfit for human consumption - for use in poultry feed, as a partial substitute for maize so as to enable the farmers to tide over the unprecedented crisis caused due to acute shortage and steep increase in the price of maize and soya meal in the domestic market. It's one of the worst crisis in the History of the Poultry Industry.

NECC sources said that during the past few years, and particularly during the past one year, there was a significant increase in the price of Maize due to various reasons beyond the control of farmers, such as increased volume of exports and diversion of significant volumes of maize for production of bio-fuel in Bihar, which is a major maize-producing State.

The price of maize in the domestic market has increased from Rs.18,000/- per ton during the last year, to approximately Rs. 25,000/- per ton presently - and" it is expected to increase further to Rs.30,000/- per ton.

NECC has stated that due to such increase in maize price, the average cost of production has gone up from Rs.4.00 per egg last year, to Rs.4.75 - Rs.5.00 presently. However, average farm gate price is hovering around Rs.3.50 per egg. thus resulting in a net loss of Rs. 1.50 to 1.75 per egg for the farmers.

Unable to withstand such continuous losses, thousands of small and marginal farmers, and even breeders have already shut down or suspended or scaled down their operations. Most of the farmers and breeders are on the verge of insolvency.

Under these circumstances partial substitution of maize with other cheaper commodities is the only viable option to help the farmers to retain their means of livelihood, as well as to ensure that eggs and chicken would continue to be available to the poorer sections of the consumers at an affordable price.

NECC sources said - "we are hopeful that the Government would respond favourably to our appeal and come to the rescue of farmers and allot the damaged grains for production of poultry feed, and enable the farmers to tide over the crisis and continue to retain their only means of livelihood"

